Find the Correct Course ID (CID)

Use before every alignment or gap-filling project

1 Answer three questions first

- [ ] **Which school year?**
  Current or upcoming. CIDs can change from one year to the next.
- [ ] **What content source?**
  Company-built, vendor, legacy, or new curriculum.
- [ ] **Base or linked course?**
  The base course, a linked school copy, or a state-specific base course.

2 Pick the right tool

Course Manager
Finding one course or a few. Fastest for a single lookup.

Course Metadata Report
Comparing many courses or locations at once in a spreadsheet.

3 Course Manager settings

Field	Set to	Why
Search Text	All or part of the course name	Works like any search bar
Curriculum	Any	Narrowing can hide the course you need
Subject Area	Any	Courses may be tagged unexpectedly
School Year	Year from step 1	CIDs change between years
Include Linked	Checked	Shows school copies with their base
Managed At	Organization root	Anything else searches the wrong catalog
Available At	Any location, or the school	Courses are tagged to schools, not states

4 Course Metadata Report settings

Field	Set to	Why
School Year(s)	Every year you need	Compare years side by side
Output Type	Excel	Inline adds data you don't need
Managed At	Organization root	The report won't run otherwise
Available At	Any location, or specific schools	Specific schools make a smaller file

Then select **Generate Report**, turn on filters, and narrow by location, school year, subject, and grade.

5 Tell base from linked

> Check the **Base Course ID** column. **Blank** means a base course. **A CID** means a linked copy of that base course.

CID	Name	Base Course ID	Result
789	Essential Math 6 A	(blank)	Base course
345	Connected Math 6 A	**789**	Linked to 789

6 Check before you start work

- [ ] **School year matches the project**
- [ ] **Course name and school or state match**
- [ ] **Base or linked matches what the project needs**

Common mistakes

- Taking the first search result without checking it
- Narrowing Curriculum or Subject Area
- Leaving Managed At on anything but the organization root
- Searching by state when courses are tagged to schools

Still not sure? Ask before you edit. A wrong CID can change a live course students are using.

Portfolio sample by Bailey Tucker. System names and data are fictional.